

Her Mother's Hands

*A cupful
of sugar, two cups of flour,
stirring with love in the morning
hours, a pinch of salt, folding, rolling, pouring out,
buttoning tiny buttons, tying bows and tennis shoes, washing
gooey faces, brushing curls, splashing, over flowing water bowls.
Teaching, reaching winter clothes, pulling open dresser drawers,
tracing clouds and touching toes, pointing the way back home.
Soft and smooth, rosy brown, soothing, waving warm. Always
full, thoughtful, beautiful, playful, patty-cake, tickling,
counting Indians and baby chicks, itsy bitsy spider
crawls, shadow wings on kitchen walls.*

Praising, praying,
Lifting souls,
patting She has
shoulders, Her Mother's
strokes Hands
flowers
crossed
over her
heart.

